

Extreme photo printing

The Epson Stylus Pro 9880 comes with as many as 8 colour ink tanks to produce high quality photo prints



Printer spying?

Invisible tracking codes are printed across every print out coming out of a color laser printer

Printer test



Performance

One thing that was very clear with mono laser printers – they had excellent text quality. With the exception of the Canon IP2900B, all of them gave excellent text prints.

Taking photo prints isn't a great idea but we tried it anyway with the mono laser printers. The first thing you notice are the horizontal lines across the images. The Canon LBP3300 was far better in this aspect with almost no lines – slightly brighter images.

Mono laser printers – above Rs. 10,000

Brother HL 2170W

The HL2170W is a monochrome laser printer which comes with the 802.11b/g wireless functionality along with network connectivity. This means that not only can the printer be connected to a wired network but can also take a print command from a system that is wirelessly connected to the network. This option is the USP of this printer.

The build is very similar to HL 2140 and HL 2150N which features a strong tray at the base.

It has 32MB of internal memory which allows you to queue more documents than the previous ones from Brother.

Setting up the wired port connection is easy but the wireless setup is quite tedious, especially if you have multiple WiFi routers in the area. Moreover, the resetting can be annoying for some. The efficiency of the USB interface and wired network connection is almost the same.

Brother HL-5240

The HL-5240 has a really basic and somewhat boring design. It's built well, and the paper tray doesn't feel as smooth as some of the more expensive printers out there. There are two side fans on this device, to aid cooling.

Although we didn't expect a lot when we first saw it, the HL-5240 impressed us with its blazing speed – there was noticeable folding of paper though. Things get noisy, but only for a while. There aren't too many controls to bother with either, but there are status lights for toner, drum and paper levels. There's even a parallel port connection for those using really old PCs.

Ricoh SP3300DN

This is the first printer that we have tested that has a facility to join an extra paper tray to the base input tray. Its uniqueness is

offset by an oddity – it does not have a USB cable bundled.

The body is quite strong and it has just one button and two light indicators. The SP3300DN comes with 32MB of onboard memory, which is extendable to 160 MB.

The SP330 is ideal for organisations that have a large document printing load. The printer also has a LAN port for network connectivity, which makes it more versatile.

Ricoh Aficio SP 4100NL

Ricoh's SP4100NL is a high-end monochrome laser printer which is super fast as far as performance goes. It has a strong body with an equally sturdy input tray at the base.

The printer has a small monochrome LCD display screen on top along with buttons for the various menus. The screen is very small and does not do justice to the features it offers. The only thing that works in favour of the screen is its bright backlight.

This printer has an onboard energy saving mode which puts it in a sort of hibernation mode when not in use. This is an important feature for large offices as laser printers are known to be heavy power users.

The small LCD screen makes matters worse when any errors shows up on the menu. Absence of a user manual or a troubleshooting guide is sorely felt, and no USB cable bundled just adds to your woes. Printing on glossy paper resulted in paper jams.

The printer is ideally suited for large offices and meant for bulk text printing. Our tests found that graphics and image output isn't great.

Performance

With the more expensive mono laser printers, quality didn't necessarily improve drastically. The



CONTACT DETAILS				
Brand	Contact	Phone	E-mail	Web site
Canon	Canon India Pvt. Ltd.	188-345-33-66	info@canon.co.in	www.canon.co.in
Brother	Brother International (India) Pvt. Ltd.	+91-22-4098 8922	info@brother.in	www.brother.in
Epson	Epson India Pvt Ltd.	+91-80-3051 5023	NA	www.epson.co.in
Ricoh	Mr. Kiran Pai	+91-11-4161 3010	ril.info@ricoh.co.in	www.ricoh.co.in